Changing behaviour

BACKGROUND

habitat (say 'hab-i-tat') – the particular place where a group of living things live

species (say 'spee-seas') – a group of living things that can breed together to produce fertile offspring

Adaptation is the name that scientists give to the way that living things change and become better suited to their habitats. They also use the word adaptation to describe the actual change.

Adaptations may be behavioural or physical. Physical adaptations in species happen over many generations, but a species can change its behaviour more easily. This is called **behavioural adaptation**.

☞ **1** What word do we use to describe the way that some organisms go through changes that help them become better suited to their environment?

_____

2 What smaller (root) word can be found in this term? a __ __ p __

3 What does the word in Question 2 mean? Circle one answer:

a) to change

b) to die

c) to stay the same

Many organisms can make outward changes to suit their environment. For example, long-haired dogs such as Siberian huskies are able to keep warm in cold habitats because of their thick coats. When a dog like this is placed in a warmer habitat it must change its behaviour so it can cope with the different temperature. It changes its behaviour, so this is behavioural adaptation.

4 Circle three behaviours that Siberian huskies could develop to help them stay cool in a warm habitat.

grow finer, shorter hair	drink more water
develop scales	lie in the shade
limit movement at certain times of the day	increase its amount of blood

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